MONA HEIGHTS
PRIMARY SCHOOL

STUDENT'S
HANDBOOK

MONA HEIGHTS PRIMARY SCHOOL
FOUNDED 1967
Virtute et Labore

National Pledge

Before God and all mankind,

I pledge the love and loyalty of my heart,

The wisdom and courage of my mind,

The strength and vigor of my body in the service of my fellow citizen: I promise to stand up for Justice, Brotherhood and Peace,

To work diligently and creatively,

To think generously and honestly,

So that Jamaica may, under God

Increase in beauty, fellowship and prosperity

And play her part in advancing the welfare of the whole human race.

The Education Regulation, Section 2 a (1) of the Education Act of 1980 read, "A student shall obey the rules of the school he is attending."

The Mona Heights Primary School handbook is provided for the convenience of students, parents/ guardians and staff alike to which they must adhere to. It sets out the Mona Heights Primary School regulations governing the school's operations, policies and guidelines, any other offerings of the institution. The current edition of the school' s handbook was finalized on August 31, 2023.

We advise both parent and child to read through the booklet together. All of us- students, parents and teachers can contribute much to the success of the school and the development of each child by working together with understanding and cooperation.

Mona Heights Primary

The school of choice!

Welcome Message

Welcome to Mona Heights Primary School we are elated to embark on this journey with you. Being a part of this esteemed school family is life changing and never monotonous. We take pride in our family and treat them with the highest regard. We have maintained over the years high standards and are a beacon in offering Primary Education to many generations.

We are committed to providing each child with a world- class Primary Education, enabling students to be the well-rounded individuals who are respectful, diligent and striving to be the best at what they do. They are being molded as responsible citizens who can contribute to the development of their school, community, country and the world.

At Mona, you will be a part of a dynamic community that aims to foster holistic development, expanding your creativity whilst maximizing your full potential. Throughout your journey with us, you will interact with individuals from various backgrounds and cultures that will aid in the reinforcement of your own beliefs and values and provide ample opportunity to exhibit your true personality.

Outlined in this handbook are the school's commitment to you. You are encouraged to familiarize yourself with the operations of the institution. Enjoy your time at Mona Heights Primary School, as you immerse yourself in a tradition of diligence and success.

Virtute et Labore

Office Procedures

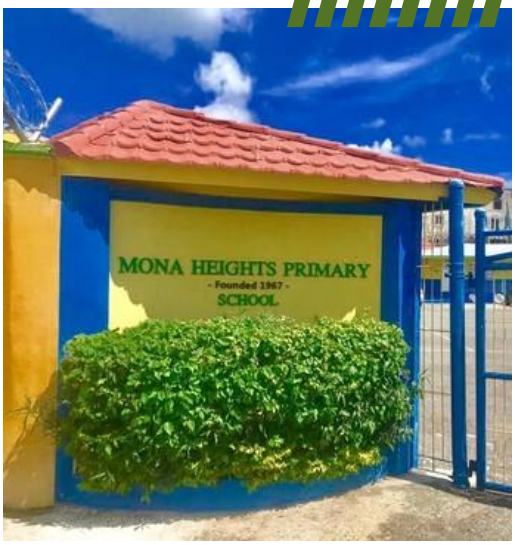
Operations

- Front office opens at 7:30 am and closes 4:00 pm, Mondays - Fridays.
- The processing of all requested documents (transcripts, admission records, etc.) will take five (5) working days and attracts a cost.
- The office is a quite zone and must be treated as such.
- Only persons who are transacting business will be allowed in the office space.

School's Profile

Mona Heights Primary was established in 1967 to meet the needs of providing Primary Education to the community of Mona Heights and its environs. Since its inception, Mona Heights Primary School has been a standard- bearer in the delivery of Primary education, not only for its immediate environment, but also for the entire island of Jamaica. Our students have been trail-blazers in academics, culture, sports, arts and numerous other areas of endeavors.

The Mona Heights Primary students wholeheartedly embrace the following ideals of the school:



- Each child must be well rounded by participating in co-curricular activities
- Strive to maintain a high academic average of 85% and over
- Is well- mannered and respectful
- Is a model to his/ her classmates/ schoolmates
- Is punctual
- Displays character traits of a good leader
- Attends school regularly

Vision

Our vision is to be the school of choice, placing emphasis on the holistic development of each pupil through academic excellence, vocational training and co-curricular activities in an enriched ICT- driven environment.

Mission

The mission of Mona Heights Primary School is to develop a learning center that is digitally enhanced - designed to facilitate wholistic learning experiences and harmonious social interaction in which each child has the opportunity to realize his/her true natural potential.

Motto

The official motto of the Mona Heights Primary School is *Virtute et Labore, 'With Courage and Effort'*. Which depicts the values and virtues we instill in our students in achieving a meaningful life and purpose.

School Colours

The school colours are green and yellow

Our School Song

Verse 1

Mona Primary our school in the city
On five acres just beside the university
At ages six to twelve we are young and pliable
But to produce the best we are able.

Chorus

Mona Primary you lay a great foundation
For a sure and wholesome lifelong education
Whatever school's our host
We'll remember you were first
So to you we lift our glasses give a cherry toast

Verse 2

We'll go through our gate one day face the future
On to secondary, high schools more exposure
Eventually we may attend the university
Just beside our little school in the city.

Chorus

Mona Primary you lay a great foundation
For a sure and wholesome lifelong education
Whatever school's our host
We'll remember you were first
So to you we lift our glasses give a cherry toast

Life at Mona

1 School Hours

- School begins at 7:45 am and ends at 2:00 pm daily except on Thursdays, we end at 1:00 pm for Planning Sessions.
- Mid- morning break is from 9:45 am - 10 am
- Lunch Break for Grades 1-3 is from 10:45 am - 11:30 am
- Lunch Break for Grades 4-6 is from 11:30 am - 12:30 pm

Parents are notified of early dismissal changes to facilitate school's matters.

2 Dress Code

All students are required to be attired in **FULL UNIFORM** at all times. Physical Education (P.E.) gears **MUST** be worn on days when students have P.E. classes.

Only black or brown shoes must be worn to school with black or brown socks. No sneakers are to be worn except for P.E classes. **ONLY** white sneakers are allowed to be worn for P.E. If for any reason a child is not dressed in the correct uniform or shoes, a letter **MUST** be sent to the teacher.

Grooming

Not Allowed:

- Jewelry
- Makeup
- Hair decoration
- Corn-row or plaited hair (males)
- Hair Beads

Allowed:

- Wrist watches
- Ear knobs or sleepers (no bigger than a $1 coin)
- Simple and moderate hair extensions for girls (natural hair colour only)
- Simple hair accessories; bubbles, clips/ribbon. (green, white, black or brown)

Clubs and Societies

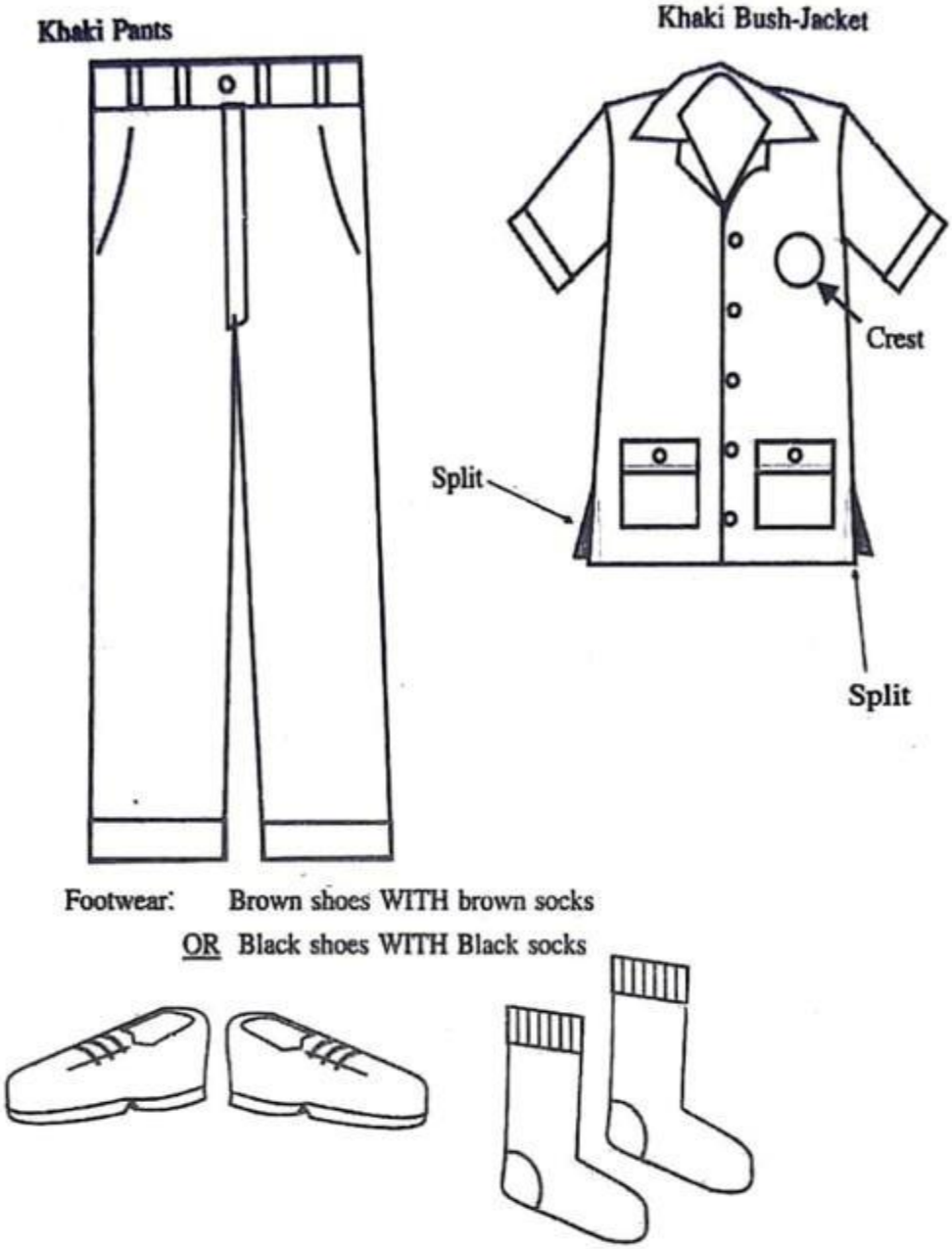
All students are mandated to be a part of a club. Clubs are held every other Friday from 1:00 pm to 2:00 pm.

Clubs include:

- Art
- Boy's Scout
- Brownie Pack
- Builders Club
- Chess
- Choir
- Culture
- Debate
- Entrepreneur
- Good News Club
- Gymnastics
- HYPE
- Integrity
- K Kids
- Mathematics
- Media
- Netball
- Quiz
- Reading
- Red Cross
- Science and Environmental
- Sewing
- Spelling
- Sports
- Squash
- Swimming
- 4 H

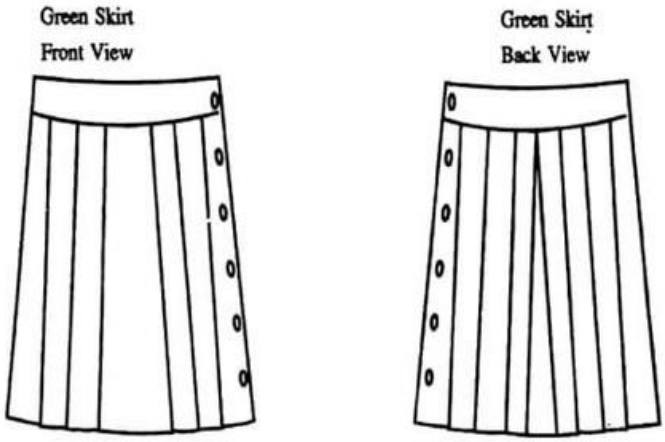
WELCOME TO THE MONA FAMILY

Male's Uniform

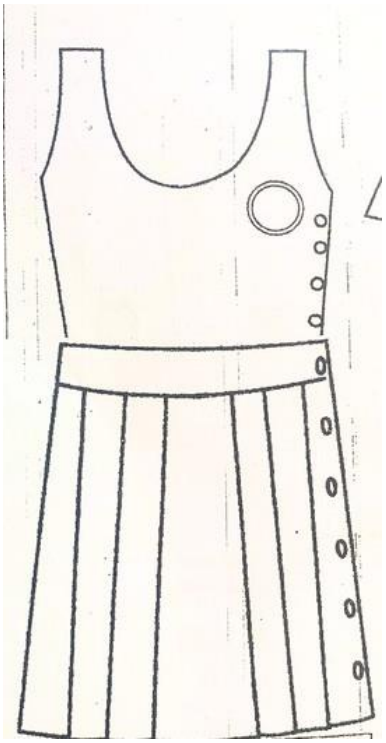


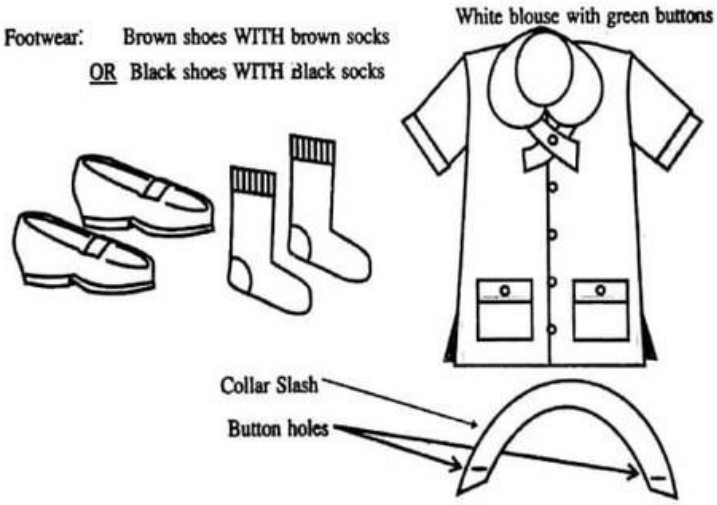
Female's Uniform

School Uniform for Grades 5-6



School Uniform for Grades 1-4 girls





School Rules

Students Conduct

- At all times, students are expected to conduct themselves in a manner that reflects order and decency.
- Behaviours not permitted by the school are: stealing, use of obscene languages, fighting and bullying. These offenses will be dealt with accordingly by the school's administration and police where required.
- Continuous breach of school rules will result in the school's disciplinary procedure being enforced which may result in suspension or expulsion from school.
- No toys, card packs, dice, comics or other similar non educational materials are allowed on school grounds.
- No weapons or any other dangerous materials or objects are allowed in school. These include but are not limited to: knives, water pistols, catapults, fireworks, lighters, matches, ice picks, razors.
- Cellphones are not permitted at school. The school's administration will **NOT** be responsible for lost or stolen cellphones.

School Rules

Classroom

- Work quietly in an orderly manner
- Respect and cooperate with other students
- Observe Safety Rules
- No chewing of gums
- Show respect to teachers and members of staff
- No running or playing on stairways or corridors

Devotion and Assemblies

- Walk quietly to and from devotion/assembly
- Be a polite and respectful member of the audience
- Sit/ stand correctly
- Do not disturb others

Play Field

- Play only in designated areas
- Respect the rights of others on the play field
- Accept guidance from teachers/ students on duty
- Respectful language only should be used
- Play games that are in accordance with the school rules
- No physical harm; kicking, hitting, throwing stones or pushing of other students are permitted

Dismissal

- All students must leave the compound by 3:30 pm unless they are involved in supervised extra - curricular activities. The school will not be responsible for students who are not collected by 3:30pm.

School Rules

Parents Conduct

- Students are not permitted to leave the school compound once they have entered. Students may be collected before dismissal by signing the Sign Out Log at the front office.
- Students who are sick must remain at home and teachers notified of their absence.
- All parents **MUST** report to the front office after entering school and receive a visitor's pass. Parents are **NOT** allowed to visit a classroom during school hours unless permitted otherwise.
- Parents are not allowed on compound after the school's morning bell rings.
- Visitors on school grounds are expected to dress appropriately. Entrance will not be granted if inappropriately dressed.
- The following attires are not permitted on school premises:
    - Tights
    - Merinos
    - Mini Skirts or Shorts
    - Sleeveless Blouse
    - Hair Rollers
    - Any other clothing that is revealing and exposing